intentionally or not – creates formidable masses of workers needing to sell their labour in the 'free' markets of Latin America, Asia, Africa and Europe. For the first time in humanity's history, the urban population in the 21st century is greater than the rural population, and the expropriation process continues unabated. From now on these conditions permit new expropriating arrangements affecting workers, already long deprived of their productive means, whose rights derived from the labour contract have now been reduced (through flexible and precarious arrangements). They also affect collective goods and conquests through the privatisation of public enterprises and the elimination of health, transport, education and media rights. They already implacably beat down all humankind by the expropriation of water resources and deprive humanity of the capacity to reproduce seeds, historically at the basis of world nourishment (rice, wheat, maize, soya).[12] This group of actions, which I call secondary expropriations, sadly reaffirm Marxist thought, according to which the social basis of capitalism demands always-increasing expropriations.

We are witnessing a profound process being experienced in a deeply unequal manner by diverse regions of the planet as well as different countries. This transformation of capitalism's scale, initiated in the post-war era and consolidated at the end of the Cold War, has also targeted politics. After 1944 a formidable strategic vision was activated in all spheres – military, business, intellectual and so on – narrating the development achieved under the intense process of social struggles; it laid the international basis for institutions that guaranteed the extraction of value in all fields and impeded any social processes that could question capital-imperialism's expansion. From the end of the 1960s, given the new global complexity, what was an embryonic form up until then transformed into a kind of political standard with great elasticity adaptable to various national conjunctures, yet extremely rigid with regard to the intransigent defence of large-scale private property.

The fifth feature of capital-imperialism focuses on the transformation of states and the democratic purpose. International relations take an interstate form based in broadly representative forums (such as the United Nations and UNESCO) plus associations with a corporate profile, under US supremacy; they joined the great powers together in dominance over the economies of the rest of the world. They aimed at ensuring the consent and adhesion of the dominant country populations to an accelerated process of international capital expansion and – given the Cold War context – in large measure dependent upon two fundamental elements present in the centre and offered as models for the remaining countries – the welfare state and democracy (reduced to representative elections).